



Generation gap

Motivation and self-awareness



Agenda

- Reading: Generations
- Vocabulary: Adjectives to describe personality
- Grammar: Participle clauses



Reading

Look at the names of the different generations, as used by demographers and the media.

- 1 **Baby Boomers** — Born 1946–1964
- 2 **Generation X** — Born 1965–1980
- 3 **Generation Y** — Born 1981–2000
- 4 **Generation Z** — Born after 2000

A

Born shortly after World War II, this generation had more opportunities in life than their parents. Optimistic and willing to work long hours, they tend to define themselves by their professional achievements. They are often **well educated** and can be quite competitive in the workplace. Outside work they
1 _____ seek enjoyment in life.

B

This generation, **joining the workforce at the start of this millennium**, is also known as the 'millennial' generation. They have different priorities from their parents, caring less about earning large salaries
2 _____. They have a (perhaps unfair) reputation for being **self-centred, arrogant** and believing they deserve the best in life. Some think this comes from constantly being told since birth
3 _____. This generation is more **open-minded** than previous ones in their attitudes to other cultures and nationalities.

C

Sometimes referred to as **Generation Net**, this generation never experienced a world without the internet. Because of the internet they are very **well informed** about world events. They are also even more **tech-savvy** than previous generations, with children as young as two being able
4 _____. This generation, **having lived through an economic recession**, probably won't take money for granted.

D

Sandwiched between Baby Boomers and Generation Y, this generation shares many of their characteristics. They ⁵_____ they value a work-life balance. A higher divorce rate and an increase in working mothers meant many from this generation grew up often being alone. They therefore tend to be independent, **family-focused** and have a **realistic** attitude to life. They also tend to be **critical** of authority.



Lektor

Grammar

- Participle clauses allow us to include more information in a single sentence. Compare:
 - This generation is sandwiched between Baby Boomers and Generation Y. It shares many of their characteristics.
 - **Sandwiched between Baby Boomers and Generation Y**, this generation shares many of their characteristics.
- Some participle clauses can replace relative clauses:
 - Generation Y, **told since birth that they are special**, (= who have been told that they are special) can sometimes be self-centred.
- The present participle has an active meaning. The past participle has a passive meaning.
 - People **growing up after World War II** (= who grew up after ...) had more opportunities than their parents.
 - Generation Z, **also known as Generation Net** (= who are also known as ...), were born in this millennium.
- We use *having + past participle* with verbs with an active meaning to make it clear we are talking about the past.
 - Generation Z, **having lived through an economic recession**, won't take money for granted.



Practice

Rewrite the questions using participle clauses.

1. What are some of the challenges which face those who work in a multi-generational workplace?
 2. In what ways are people who were brought up in the age of social media different from older generations?
 3. What are the factors which affect the beliefs and attitudes of a generation?
 4. How do you think people who are born after 2020 will be different?
 5. What differences have you noticed between people who have been working for many years and those who have just started their careers?
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 2. In what ways are people **brought up** in the age of social media different from older generations?
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 4. How do you think people **born after 2020** will be different?
 5. What differences have you noticed between people **working for many years** and those **just starting their careers**?



That's all, folks!

